Given this situation, it was decided that the R&AW, while pursuing espionage operations, should also be tasked with successfully executing psychological warfare. Intelligence operations are conducted by rules and operatives are free to apply and use all kinds of ammunition to defeat inimical forces.

There are tough lessons for the R&AW from both intelligence successes and setbacks in the Khalistan operation as Pakistan looks to revive the militancy on the basis of the global exposure expected during referendum 2020 agitations in foreign countries. There is a growing need for analysts in the digital battlespace. A proposal has been moved by the government extending immunity to cyber decoys recruited to counter propaganda and criminal activities in the virtual world. For successful future operations on the ground, a decision has been taken to set up a joint counter operation centre involving the R&AW, the National Investigation Agency (NIA), the IB and the Punjab Police. The decision taken during a meeting of top security officials in early 2019 also finalised a blueprint to hire the services of retired officers and spies who had served in Punjab during the peak of the Khalistan movement. The aim is to ensure the Indian spies have superior resources to pre-empt any ISI move.